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GDS (Conduct and Engagement) RULES, 2020 & General Conditions

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GRAMIN DAK SEVAKS (CONDUCT AND ENGAGEMENT) RULES, 2020

In supersession of the Department of Posts, Gramin Dak Sevaks (Conduct and Engagement) Rules, 2011, except as respects things done or omitted to be done before such supersession, the following rules are issued under the authority of the Government of India.

Rule 3. Definitions**Gramin Dak Sevak**

The following table describes the categories of Gramin Dak Sevaks:

S.No.	GDS Post	Description of Post
1	Branch Postmaster (BPM)	GDS Working as Postmaster in Branch Office.
2	Assistant Branch Postmaster (ABPM)	GDS other than BPM and working in Branch Office are designated as ABPM.
3	Dak Sevak	GDS other than BPM/ABPM working in Head office, Sub office or RMS office.

Members of Family

The wife, child or step child of such Sevak, whether residing with him or not, and in relation to a Sevak who is a woman, the husband residing with her and dependent on her and any other person related, whether by blood or by marriage to such Sevak or to such Sevak's wife or husband and wholly dependent on such Sevak, but does not include a wife or husband legally separated from such Sevak or a child or step child who is no longer in any way dependent upon such Sevak or of whose custody the Sevak has been deprived by any law; only widow and dependent Daughter-in-law.

Rule 3.A. Terms and Conditions of Engagement

- A Sevak shall not be required to perform duty beyond a maximum period of **5 hours** in a day.
- A Sevak shall not be retained beyond **65 years** of age.

- A Sevak shall have to give an undertaking that he has other sources of income besides the allowances paid or to be paid by the Government for adequate means of livelihood for himself and his family.
- A Sevak can be transferred from one postal unit to another in public interest/vigilance and administrative ground.
- A Sevak shall be outside the Civil Service of the Union.
- A Sevak shall not claim to be at par with the Central Government employees.
- Residence in post village/delivery jurisdiction of the Post Office within **one month** after selection but before engagement shall be mandatory for a Sevak; Failure to reside in place of duty for GDS BPM & within delivery jurisdiction of the Post Office for other categories of Gramin Dak Sevaks after engagement shall be treated as violative of conditions of engagement and liable for disciplinary action under Rule 10 of the Conduct & Engagement Rules.
- Post Office shall be located in the accommodation to be provided by Gramin Dak Sevak Branch Postmaster suitable for use as Post Office premises. However, where accommodation is provided for Post Offices by the Central/State Government/local Government/Village Panchayat etc. the same will be used for Post Office premises.
- Combination of duties of a Sevak shall be permissible.

Rule 3.B. Eligibility Criteria for Engagement to Gramin Dak Sevaks Posts

Age Criteria

The minimum and maximum age for the purpose of engagement to GDS posts shall be **18 years** and **40 years** respectively as on the date of notification of the vacancy.

Relaxation in Upper Age

S.No.	Category	Permissible Age Relaxation
1	SC/ST	5 Years
2	OBC	3 Years

3	EWS	No relaxation
4	PwD/PH	10 Years
5	PwD/PH + SC/ST	15 Years
6	PwD/PH + OBC	13 Years

The persons belonging to EWSs who are not covered under the scheme of reservation for SCs, STs and OBCs shall get **10%** reservation in engagement to Gramin Dak Sevaks posts in the Department of Posts as prescribed in Directorate letter No 17-09/2019 dated **26.02.2019**.

All engaging authorities shall maintain the above age relaxation for persons with disability for all categories of GDS posts. This relaxation however is not applicable for persons with benchmark of disability "Blind", as in place of blind, candidate with low vision have been identified as prescribed in Directorate letter No. 17-8/2017-GDS dated **26.02.2019**.

Categories of Disability Suitable for the Post (BPM/ABPM/GDS)

- **(a)** (LV) Low Vision
- **(b)** D (Deaf), HH (Hard of Hearing)
- **(c)** One Arm (OA), One Leg (OL), Leprosy cured, Dwarfism, Acid Attack victim
- **(d)** Specific Learning disability
- Multiple disabilities from amongst disabilities mentioned at (a) to (d) above except Deaf and Blindness.

Educational Qualification

Secondary School Examination Pass certificate of 10th Standard with passing marks in Mathematics and English as compulsory/elective subject conducted by a recognized board of Central/State/UT.

Compulsory Knowledge of Local Language

The candidate should have studied the local language at least up to 10th standard (as compulsory or elective subjects) as declared by the State Government or as per

constitutional provisions relating to the 8th schedule of Constitution of India as prescribed by the Department from time to time.

Basic Computer Training

An undertaking has to be submitted by the candidate declaring that he/she has adequate knowledge to operate Computer desktop/laptop/PoS/mobile etc. to work on the Departmental software, (vide No. 17-02/2018-GDS dated **11.05.2022**).

Adequate Means of Livelihood

Selected candidate shall be required to comply with this prescribed condition within **30 days** after selection but before engagement. The GDS will also have to ensure that he/she is having adequate additional means of livelihood during the period of engagement till his discharge.

Furnishing of Security

Deleted (vide No. 17-02/2018-GDS dated **11.05.2022**).

Method of Engagement

Exemption of Fee for Applying on GDS Posts

Male applicants belonging to the category UR/OBC/EWS have to pay a fee as **Rs. 100/-**. Payment of fee is exempted for all female candidates, all SC/ST candidates, all PwD candidates and Transwomen candidate.

IPPB Incentive Clarification

The work performed for IPPB will not be included in calculation of TRCA. Since the same is being done on incentive basis.

Adequate Representation of SC/ST/OBC, Persons with Disability & Economically Weaker Sections (EWSs)

The instructions issued by the Department vide no.19-11/97-ED & TRG dated **27.11.1997**, No. 17-08/2017-GDS dated **26.02.2019** and No.17-09/2019-GDS dated **26.02.2019** providing for adequate representation of SC/ST/OBC communities, Persons with Disability and Economically Weaker Sections (EWSs) respectively will continue to apply.

Production of SC/ST/OBC/Disability/Economically Weaker Sections Certificate

Production of SC/ST/OBC/Disability/EWSs certificate in the prescribed format would be compulsory in case of such candidates.

Time Related Continuity Allowance (TRCA)

(i) The following Minimum TRCA shall be payable to the different categories of GDS posts as mentioned in Directorate Order No 17-31/2016-GDS dated **25.06.2018** and letter no. 17-2/2018-GDS dated **22.03.2019** and as may be prescribed by the Government on the basis of workload/revenue norms as per the standard of assessment decided by the department from time to time:

Minimum TRCA of all categories of GDS as per Working Hours/Levels:

Sl. No.	Category	Minimum TRCA for 4 Hours/level 1	Minimum TRCA for 5 Hours/level 2
1	BPM	Rs. 12,000/-	Rs. 14,500/-
2	ABPM/Dak Sevaks	Rs. 10,000/-	Rs. 12,000/-

(ii) However, in respect of the GDSs engaged on or after **01.07.2018**, the initial fixation of TRCA will be done on the first stage of Level 1 of the respective category.

Method of Engagement

Method of engagement will continue to be as online engagement process for engagement of all categories of GDS as prescribed from time to time.

(i) Exemption of fee for applying on GDS Posts:

Male applicants belonging to the category UR/OBC/EWS have to pay a fee as prescribed. Payment of fee is exempted for all female candidates, all SC/ST candidates and all PwD candidates.

Job Profile

(i) BRANCH POSTMASTER (BPM):

The Job Profile of Branch Postmaster will include managing affairs of GDS Branch Post Office, India Post Payments Bank (IPPB) and ensuring uninterrupted counter operation during the prescribed working hours using the handheld device/Smartphone supplied by the Department. The overall management of postal facilities, maintenance of records, upkeep of handheld device, ensuring online transactions, and marketing of Postal, India Post Payments Bank services and procurement of business in the villages or Gram Panchayats within the jurisdiction of the Branch Post Office should rest on the shoulders of Branch Postmasters. However, the work performed for IPPB will not be included in calculation of TRCA, since the same is being done on incentive basis. Branch Postmaster will be the team leader of the GDS Post Office and will have overall responsibility of smooth and timely functioning of Post Office including mail conveyance and mail delivery. He/she might be assisted by Assistant Branch Postmaster of the same Branch Post Office. BPM will be required to do combined duties of ABPMs as and when ordered. He/she will also be required to do marketing, organizing melas, business procurement and any other work assigned by IP/ASP/SPOs/SSPOs/SRM/SSRM etc. In some of the Branch Post Offices, the BPM has to do all the work of BPM/ABPM.

(ii) ASSISTANT BRANCH POSTMASTER (ABPM):

The Job Profile of Assistant Branch Postmaster will include all functions of sale of stamps/stationery, conveyance and Delivery of mail at doorstep deposits/payments/other transactions under IPPB, assisting Branch Postmasters in counter duties using the handheld device/Smart phone supplied by the Department. However, the work performed for IPPB will not be included in calculation of TRCA, since the same is being done on incentive basis. He/She will also be required to do marketing, organizing melas, business procurement and any other work assigned by the Branch Postmaster or IP/ASP/SPOs/SSPOs/SRM/SSRM etc. ABPMs will also be required to do Combined Duty of BPMs as and when ordered.

(iii) DAK SEVAK:

The Job Profile of Dak Sevaks will include all functions viz sale of stamps and stationery, conveyance and delivery of mail and any other duties assigned by Postmaster/Sub Postmaster including IPPB work in the Departmental Post Offices/RMS. However, the

work performed for IPPB will not be included in calculation of TRCA, since the same is being done on incentive basis. He/She may also have to assist Postmasters/Sub Postmasters in managing the smooth functioning of Departmental Post Offices and do marketing, business procurement or any other work assigned by the Postmaster or IP/ASP/SPOs/SSPOs/SRM/SSRM etc.

Rule 3-C: Voluntary Discharge Schemes

All categories of Gramin Dak Sevaks (GDSs) can avail of the Voluntary Discharge Scheme on completion of **20 years** of engagement period or on medical grounds as per instructions issued from time to time by the Department.

Rule 4: Engaging Authority

(1) The Engaging Authority in respect of each category of Sevak shall be as shown in the Schedule annexed to these rules.

(2) If any doubt arises as to who is the appropriate Authority in any case, the matter shall be referred to the Director General (Posts), whose decision thereon shall be final.

(3) Notwithstanding anything contained in these rules, any authority superior to the Engaging Authority as shown in the Schedule under Rule 31 of GDS (Conduct & Engagement) Rules, 2020 may, at any time, either on its own motion or otherwise call for the records relating to the engagement of Gramin Dak Sevaks made by the Engaging Authority, and if such Engaging Authority appears:-

- (a) to have exercised a jurisdiction not vested in it by any law or rules time being in force; or
- (b) to have failed to exercise a jurisdiction so vested; or
- (c) to have acted in the exercise of its jurisdiction illegally or with material irregularity, such superior authority may, after giving an opportunity of being heard, make such order as it thinks fit directing the engaging authority to act under Rule 8 of GDS (Conduct & Engagement) Rules or to have initiated action to remove from engagement after following the procedure laid down under Rule 10 of the Rules including order for cancellation/rectification of the engagement process.

Rule 5: Powers of the Engaging Authority

The powers of the Engaging Authority in the matter of awarding any of the penalties specified in Rule 9 may be exercised by an authority which has been shown in the Schedule annexed to these rules or by any other authority empowered in this behalf by a special order of the Head of the Circle or the Head of the Region under circumstances to be recorded in writing

Provided that in no case, the authority so appointed shall be lower in rank than the authority who originally engaged the Gramin Dak Sevak

Rule 6: Pension/GDS Gratuity/Severance Amount

The Garmin Dak Sevaks shall not be entitled to any pension However, they shall be entitled to GDS gratuity, Severance amount or SDBS as may be decided by the Government from time to time.

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** For Gramin Dak Sevaks, the subscription towards the Service Discharge Benefit Scheme (SDBS) begins only after the completion of **one year** from the date of joining. (Updated 2026).

Rule 7: Leave

The Gramin Dak Sevaks may be granted paid leave at the rate of **20 days** in a year (**10 days** for every half year) without accumulation or as may be determined by the Government, from time to time:

Provided that -

- (a) where a Sevak fails to resume duty on the expiry of the maximum period of leave admissible and granted to him/her, or
- (b) where such a Sevak who is granted leave for a period less than the maximum period admissible to him/her under these rules, remains absent from duty for any period which together with the leave granted exceeds the limit up to which he/she could have been granted such leave, he/she shall, unless the Government, in view of the exceptional circumstances of the case, otherwise decides, be removed from engagement after following the procedure laid down in Rule 10.

Rule 7-A: Emergency Leave

Gramin Dak Sevak shall be entitled for 'Emergency' leave for a maximum of **5 days** in a calendar year, or as may be prescribed by the Government from time to time.

Rule 7-B: Maternity Leave for Female GDS

A female Gramin Dak Sevak (GDS) with less than two surviving children may be granted maternity leave by an authority competent to grant leave for a period of **180 days** from the date of its commencement, as per instructions issued by the Department from time to time.

Rule 8. Termination of Engagement

The engagement of a Sevak who has not already rendered more than **three years'** continuous engagement from the date of his/her engagement shall be liable to be terminated at any time by a notice in writing given either by the Sevak to the Engaging Authority, or by the Engaging Authority or any Authority to which the Engaging Authority is subordinate or any other Authority empowered in that behalf by the Government, by general or special order, to the Sevak.

The period of such notice shall be **one month**. Provided that the engagement of any such Sevak may be terminated forthwith and on such termination, the Sevak shall be entitled to claim a sum equivalent to the amount of Basic Time Related Continuity Allowance plus Dearness Allowance as admissible for the period of the notice at the same rates at which was drawing them immediately before the termination of his/her engagement, or, as the case may be, for the period by which such notice falls short of **one month**.

NOTE 1: Where the intended effect of such termination has to be immediate, it should be mentioned that **one month's** Time Related Continuity Allowance plus Dearness Allowance as admissible is being remitted to the Sevak in lieu of notice of **one month** through money order.

NOTE 2: When engagement of a GDS is terminated under this Rule, he/she shall not be eligible for GDS Gratuity and Severance amount etc.

Rule 9. Nature of Penalties**Minor Penalties**

1. Censure.
2. Debarring of a Sevak from appearing in the recruitment examination for the post of Multi-Tasking Staff and/or Postman and/or Mail Guard and/or from being considered for recruitment as Postal Assistant/Sorting Assistant for a period not exceeding **3 years**.
3. Debarring of a Sevak from being considered for recruitment to Multi-Tasking Staff on the basis of selection-cum-seniority for a period not exceeding **three years**.
4. Recovery from Time Related Continuity Allowance (TRCA) of the whole or part of any pecuniary loss caused to the Government by negligence or breach of orders.
5. Withholding of annual increase in Time Related Continuity Allowance (TRCA) without cumulative effect for a period not exceeding **three years**.

Major Penalties

6. Reduction to a lower stage in the TRCA slab for a specified period exceeding **three years** (not in nature of permanent measure) with further direction as to whether or not the Sevak will earn annual increase during the period of reduction and whether on expiry of such period, the reduction will or will not have the effect of postponing the future increase of his/her Time Related Continuity Allowance (TRCA).
7. Compulsory Discharge from engagement with monetary benefits (i.e. SDBS etc.) and GDS Gratuity proportionate to engagement period rendered by GDS.
8. Removal from engagement which shall not be a disqualification for future engagement.
9. Dismissal from engagement, which shall ordinarily be a disqualification for future engagement.

Rule 10-A.

Procedure for Imposing Minor Penalty

- (i) No order imposing any of the penalties specified in Clause (1) to (5) of Rule 9 shall be passed on a GDS except after:

- (a) The Sevak is informed in writing of the proposal to take action against him/her and of the allegation on which it is proposed to be taken and given an opportunity to make any representation he/she may wish to make; and
- (b) Such representation, if any, is taken into consideration by the engaging Authority.

Rule 10-B.**Procedure for Imposing Major Penalty**

(i) No order imposing any of the penalties specified in clause (6) to (9) of Rule 9 shall be passed on a GDS except after:

- (a) The Sevak is informed in writing of the proposal to take action against him/her and of the allegation on which it is proposed to be taken and given an opportunity to make any representation he/she may wish to make; and
- (b) Such representation, if any, is taken into consideration by the Engaging Authority.

Rule 10-C.**The Record of Proceedings**

The record of Proceedings shall include: (i) A copy of the intimation to the Sevak of the proposal to take action against him/her. (ii) A copy of the statement of allegations, along with a list of evidence in support thereof, communicated to him/her. (iii) His/her representation, if any. (iv) The records of the inquiry proceedings along with the inquiry report of the Engaging Authority or Inquiry Officer, if any, appointed in a case where a formal inquiry is necessary. (v) The representation, if any of the Sevak on the Inquiry Officer's report. (vi) Findings of the Engaging Authority in respect of the allegations. (vii) The order imposing the penalty.

Rule 10-D.**Mandatory Inquiry for Major Penalties**

Inquiry has to be conducted even if the GDS accepts the charges in the cases where major penalty is to be imposed by Engaging Authority. The purpose of holding inquiry in such

cases is primarily to give the GDS adequate opportunity to defend himself/herself. In case the charge is accepted by him/her unconditionally, there would obviously be no need for an inquiry for imposing major penalty.

Rule 10-E.

Discretionary Inquiry for Minor Penalties

Normally, there is no need for conduct of an inquiry for imposing minor penalty to GDS. However, where a minor penalty is to be imposed under Rule 10, it is up to the discretion of Disciplinary Authority to decide whether an inquiry should be held or not in case of a request by the delinquent GDS received by the Disciplinary/Engaging Authority.

The implication of this rule is that, on receipt of representation of delinquent GDS concerned on the imputations of misconduct or misbehaviour communicated to him/her, the Disciplinary/Engaging Authority should apply its mind to all facts and circumstances and reasons urged in the representation for holding a detailed inquiry and form an opinion whether an inquiry is necessary or not.

In a case where delinquent GDS has asked for inspection of certain documents and cross-examination of the prosecution witnesses, the Disciplinary/Engaging Authority should naturally apply its mind more closely to the request and should not reject the request solely on the ground that an inquiry is not mandatory.

If the records indicate that, notwithstanding the points urged by the delinquent GDS, the Disciplinary/Engaging Authority could, after due consideration, come to the conclusion that an inquiry is not necessary, it should say so in writing indicating its reasons, instead of rejecting the request for holding inquiry summarily without any indication that it has applied its mind to the request, as such an action could be construed as denial of natural justice.

Rule 10-F.

Procedure for Imposing Penalty After Discharge

The departmental proceedings under rule 10, if instituted while a Sevak was in engagement shall after the discharge of the Sevak on attaining the age of **sixty five years** be deemed to be proceedings under that rule and shall be continued and concluded by the authority by which the proceedings were commenced in the same manner as if the

Sevak had continued in engagement and in such case the function of the disciplinary authority shall be only to reach a finding on the charges and to submit a report recording its findings to the President and the final decision on such report shall be taken in the same manner as in the case of review petitions of the Sevaks addressed to the President and no appeal shall lie against such decision.

The President reserves to himself the right of withholding group insurance amount, security amount, post engagement benefits like ex gratia gratuity/ GDS Gratuity and severance amount of a Sevak, by ordering recovery from these amounts in case a Sevak is found guilty of grave misconduct or negligence during the period of his engagement.

For the purpose of this rule, departmental proceedings shall be deemed to be instituted on the date on which statement of charge is issued to the Sevak or if Sevak had been put off duty, on the date on which he/she had been so put off.

Rule 10-G.

Procedure for Disciplinary Proceedings After Discharge

1. (a) The departmental proceedings under Rule 10, if not instituted and the GDS is discharged on attaining of age of **65 years** and his/her terminal benefits have not been released on the ground that, departmental proceedings under Rule 10 were proposed to be instituted shall be instituted after the discharge of the Sevak on attaining the age of **Sixty Five years** and be deemed to be proceedings under that rule and shall be continued and concluded by the authority by which the proceedings were proposed to be instituted and in such case, the function of the Disciplinary Authority shall be only to reach a finding on the charges and to submit a report recording its findings to the President and the final decision on such report shall be taken in the same manner as in the case of review petitions of the Sevaks addressed to the President and no appeal shall lie against such decision.
- (b) Provided that departmental proceedings are not instituted while the GDS was in engagement, before his discharge:
 - (i) Shall not be instituted save with the sanction of the President.
 - (ii) Shall not be in respect of any event which took place more than **four years** before such institution; and

- (iii) Shall be conducted by such authority and in such place as the President may direct and in accordance with the procedure applicable to departmental proceeding in which an order of dismissal from engagement could be made in relation to the GDS during his/her engagement.

(c) The President reserves to himself/herself the right of withholding security amount, post-engagement benefits like GDS gratuity and Severance Amount of a Sevak, by ordering recovery from these amounts in case a Sevak is found guilty of grave misconduct or negligence during the period of his/her engagement.

2. For the purpose of this Rule:

- (i) Departmental proceedings shall be deemed to be instituted on the date on which the statement of charges is issued to the Gramin Dak Sevak or discharged Gramin Dak Sevak or if the Gramin Dak Sevak has been placed under Put Off Duty from an earlier date, on such date; and
- (ii) Judicial proceedings shall be deemed to be instituted, -
 - (a) in the case of criminal proceedings, on the date on which the complaint or report of a police officer, of which the magistrate takes cognizance is made; and
 - (b) in the case of civil proceedings, on the date the plaint is presented in the court.

Rule 11. Provisions of Rule 10 Shall Not Apply

(i) Where any penalty is imposed on a Sevak on the ground of conduct which has led to his/her conviction on a criminal charge; or

(ii) Where the Authority empowered to dismiss or remove a Sevak is satisfied that for some reason, to be recorded by that authority in writing, it is not reasonably practicable to hold such enquiry; or

(iii) Where the President is satisfied that in the interest of the security of the State it is not expedient to follow the procedure prescribed in that rule and the Engaging Authority may consider the circumstances of the case and make such orders thereon as it deems fit.

Rule 12. Put off Duty

The Engaging Authority or any authority to which the Engaging Authority is subordinate or any other authority empowered in that behalf by the Government, by general or special order, may put a Sevak off duty:

- Where a disciplinary proceeding against him/her is contemplated or is pending; or
- Where a case against him/her in respect of any criminal offence is under investigation, inquiry or trial.

Provided that in cases involving fraud or embezzlement, the Sevak holding any post specified in the Schedule to these rules may be put off duty by the Inspector of Post Offices or the Assistant Superintendent of Post Offices of the Sub-Division, as the case may be, under immediate intimation to the Engaging Authority.

Where Inspector of Post Offices or the Assistant Superintendent of Post Offices of the Sub-Division is not the Engaging Authority, an order made by them shall cease to be effective on the expiry of **15 days** from the date of such order unless earlier confirmed or cancelled by the Engaging Authority or the Authority to which the Engaging Authority is subordinate.

A Sevak shall be entitled to an amount of compensation as ex-gratia payment equal to **25%** of his/her Time Related Continuity Allowance (TRCA) together with admissible Dearness Allowance per month for the period of put off duty.

Provided that where the period of put off duty exceeds **90 days**, the Engaging Authority or the authority to which the Engaging Authority or any other authority empowered in this behalf, as the case may be, who made the order of put off duty shall be competent to vary the amount of compensation for any period subsequent to the period of first **90 days**.

- The amount of compensation as ex-gratia payment may be increased by a suitable amount, not exceeding **50%** of such compensation admissible during the period of the first **90 days**, if in the opinion of the said authority the period of put off duty has been prolonged, for reasons to be recorded in writing, not directly attributable to the Sevak.

- The amount of compensation as ex-gratia payment may be reduced by a suitable amount not exceeding **50%** of such compensation admissible during the first **90 days**, if in the opinion of the said authority, the period of put off duty has been prolonged due to reasons to be recorded in writing directly attributable to the Sevak.

Provided that a Sevak who has been absconding or remains absent unauthorizedly and is subsequently put off duty shall not be entitled to any compensations as ex-gratia payment.

Provided further that in the event of departmental proceedings initiated against a GDS (who was placed under put off duty) for imposition of major penalty finally ends with the imposition of a minor penalty, the Sevak concerned should, be paid full Time Related Continuity Allowance and allowances for the period of put off duty.

Rule 13. Appeal

A Sevak may appeal against an order putting him/her off duty to the authority to which the authority passing the order regarding putting him/her off duty is immediately subordinate.

A Sevak may appeal against an order imposing on him/her any of the penalties specified in Rule 9 to the authority to which the authority imposing the penalty is immediately subordinate.

Rule 14. Period of limitation for Appeal

No appeal shall be entertained unless it is submitted within a period of **three months** from the date on which the appellant receives a copy of the order appealed against, provided that the Appellate Authority may entertain the appeal after the expiry of the said period, if it is satisfied that the appellant had sufficient cause for not submitting the appeal in time.

Rule 18. Consideration of Appeal

The Appellate Authority shall consider:

- (a) whether the procedure specified in these rules has been complied with;
- (b) whether the findings are justified; and

- (c) whether the penalty imposed is excessive, adequate or inadequate and passing orders,
 - (i) setting aside, reducing, confirming or enhancing the penalty;
 - (ii) remitting the case to the authority which imposed the penalty or to any other authority with such direction as it may deem fit in the circumstances of the case, provided that no order imposing an enhanced penalty shall be passed unless the appellant is given an opportunity of making any representation which he may wish to make against such enhanced penalty.

Rule 19. Revisions

The following authorities may, at any time, either on its own motion or otherwise call for records of any enquiry or disciplinary case and revise an order made under these rules, reopen the case and after making such enquiry as it considers necessary:

- (i) Regional PMG, for those Gramin Dak Sevaks who work in region headed by PMG; and in the rest of the cases by the Head of the Circle/Chief Postmaster General;
- (ii) Any other authority immediately superior to the authority passing the orders; or
- (iii) Any other authority specified in this behalf by the Government by general or special order, and within such time as may be specified in that general or special order.

Such authorities may:

- (a) confirm, modify or set aside the order; or
- (b) pass such orders as it deems fit.

Provided that no such case shall be reopened under this rule after the expiry of **six months** from the date of the order to be revised except by the Government or by the Head of Circle or by the Postmaster-General (Region); and also before the expiry of the time limit of **three months** specified for preferring an appeal under Rule 14.

Rule 20. Review

The President may, at any time, either on his own motion or otherwise, review an order passed under these rules when any new material or evidence which could not be produced or was not available at the time of passing the order under review and which has the effect of changing the nature of the case, has come, or has been brought to his notice.

GDS CONDUCT RULES**Rule 21. General**

Every Sevak shall at all times:-

(i) maintain absolute integrity; (ii) maintain devotion to duty; and (iii) do nothing which is unbecoming of a Sevak.

Rule 21-A. Promptness and Courtesy

No Sevak Shall:-

(i) in the performance of his/her official duties, act in a discourteous manner; (ii) in his/her official dealing with the public or otherwise adopt dilatory tactics or willfully cause delay in disposal of the work assigned to him.

Rule 21-B. Prohibition of Sexual Harassment of Working Women

(1) No Gramin Dak Sevak shall indulge in any act of sexual harassment of any woman at any workplace.

(2) Every Sevak who is in charge of a workplace shall take appropriate steps to prevent sexual harassment to any woman at such workplace.

EXPLANATION: 1. For the purpose of this Rule:-

(a) "Sexual Harassment" includes any one or more of the following acts or behavior, (whether directly or by implication), namely:- (i) physical contact and advances; or (ii) a demand or request for sexual favours; or (iii) making sexually coloured remarks; or (iv)

showing pornography; or (v) any other unwelcome physical, verbal, non-verbal conduct of a sexual nature.

(b) The following circumstances, among other circumstances, if it occurs or is present in relation to or connected with any act or behavior of sexual harassment may amount to sexual harassment:- (i) implied or explicit promise of preferential treatment in employment/engagement; or (ii) implied or explicit threat of detrimental treatment in employment/engagement; or (iii) implied or explicit threat about her present or future employment /engagement status; or (iv) interference with her work or creating an intimidating or offensive or hostile work environment for her; or (v) Humiliating treatment likely to affect her health or safety.

(c) "Workplace" includes,- (i) any department, organisation, undertaking, establishment, enterprise, institution, office, branch or unit which is established, owned, controlled or wholly or substantially financed by funds provided directly or indirectly by the Central Government; (ii) hospitals or nursing homes; (iii) any sports institute, stadium, sports complex or competition or games venue, whether residential or not used for training, sports or other activities relating thereto; (iv) any place visited by the employee/GDS arising out of or during the course of employment/engagement including transportation provided by the employer for undertaking such journey; (v) a dwelling place or a house.

Rule 22. Taking part in Politics and Elections

(1) No Sevak shall be a member of, or be otherwise associated with, any political party or any organization which takes part in politics nor shall he/she take part in, subscribe in aid of, or assist in any other manner, any political movement or activity.

(2) It shall be the duty of every Sevak to endeavor to prevent any member of the family from taking part in, subscribing in aid of, or assisting in any other manner, any political movement or activity which is, or tends directly or indirectly to be, subversive of the Government as by law established, and where a Sevak is unable to prevent a member of his/her family from taking part in, or subscribing in aid of, or assisting in any other manner, any such movement or activity, he/she shall make a report to that effect to the Government.

(3) If any question arises whether a party is a political party or whether any organization takes part in politics or whether any movement or activity falls within the scope of sub-rule (2), the decision of the Government thereon shall be final.

(4) No Sevak shall canvass or otherwise interfere with or use his/her influence in connection with, or take part in an election to any legislative or local authority.

Provided that-

(i) A Sevak qualified to vote at such election may exercise his/her right to vote, but where he/she does so, he/she shall give no indication of the manner in which he/she proposes to vote or has voted; (ii) A Sevak shall not be deemed to have contravened the provisions of this rule by reason only that he/she assists in the conduct of an election in the due performance of a duty imposed on him/her by or under any law for the time being in force.

EXPLANATION: The display by a Sevak on his/her person, vehicle or residence of any electoral symbol shall amount to using his/her influence in connection with an election within the meaning of this sub-rule.

Rule 23. Strikes

No Sevak shall resort to or abet any form of strike, coercion or physical duress in connection with any matter pertaining to his/her conditions of engagement or the engagement of any other Sevak.

Period of strike shall be treated as under:-

(i) The period of strike will not only result in deduction of TRCA for the period of absence during the strike but also break in engagement on account of incitement, violence and sabotage. GDS who resort to action of the above kind violate Rule 23 of GDS (Conduct and Engagement) Rules, 2020 and disciplinary action can also be taken against them. It may be noted that the list of activities which are covered under the definition of strike as enumerated above is only illustrative and not exhaustive. It only clarifies the position in respect of practices which are often resorted to at present.

(ii) GDS who is absent from engagement hours for participating in the strike shall not be entitled to draw TRCA, DA, bonus, Paid leave TRCA etc.

(iii) The strike period shall not be adjusted or regularised by grant of any kind of leave.

(iv) If, it is specifically ordered by the competent authority after show cause notice on account of incitement, violence and sabotage, the strike period would also result in break in engagement.

(v) The strike period would not qualify towards engagement period for payment of GDS Gratuity, Severance amount at the time of discharge from engagement.

(vi) The strike period would not qualify towards engagement period for absorption of GDS against Multi-Tasking Staff (MTS) posts, which is done on seniority basis.

(vii) The strike period would not qualify towards engagement period of GDS to appear at the LDCE for the cadre of Postal Assistant /Sorting Assistant/Postmen/MailGuard/Multi-Tasking Staff etc.

(viii) The above action as per para (i) to (vii) may also be taken without prejudice to any disciplinary action that may be taken against such GDS.

Rule 24. Criticism of Government

No Sevak shall, in any radio broadcast or in any document published in his/her own name or anonymously, or pseudonymously or in the name of any other person or in any communication to the Press or in any public utterance, make any statement of fact or opinion:-

(i) which has the effect of any adverse criticism of any current or recent policy or action of the Central Government or a State Government; or (ii) which is capable of embarrassing the relations between the Central Government and the Government of any State; or (iii) which is capable of embarrassing the relations between the Central Government and the Government of any foreign State.

Provided that nothing in this rule shall apply to any statement made or views expressed by a Sevak in his/her official capacity or in the due performance of the duties assigned to him.

Rule 25. Evidence Before Committee or Any Other Authority

(1) Save as provided in sub-rule (3), no Sevak shall, except with the previous sanction of the Government, give evidence in connection with any inquiry conducted by any person, committee or authority.

(2) Where any sanction has been accorded under sub-rule (1), no Sevak giving such evidence shall criticize the policy or any action of the Central Government or of a State Government.

(3) Nothing in this rule shall apply to-

(a) evidence given at an inquiry before an authority appointed by the Government, Parliament or a State Legislative; or

(b) evidence given in any judicial inquiry; or

(c) evidence given at any departmental enquiry ordered by authorities subordinate to the Government.

Rule 26. Unauthorized Communication of Information

No Sevak shall, except in accordance with any general or special order of the Government or in the performance in good faith of the duties assigned to him/her, communicate, directly or indirectly, any official document or information to any Sevak or any other person to whom he/she is not authorized to communicate such documents or information.

EXPLANATION: Quotation by a Sevak (in his/her representation to the Engaging Authority, Head of Office, or Head of Department, or President) of or from any letter, circular, or office memorandum or from the notes in any file, to which he/she is not authorized to have access, or which he/she is not authorized to keep in his/her personal custody or for personal purposes, shall amount to unauthorized communication of information within the meaning of this rule.

Rule 27. Insolvency and Habitual Indebtedness

A Sevak shall so manage his private affairs as to avoid habitual indebtedness or insolvency.

A Sevak against whom any legal proceeding is instituted for the recovery of any debt due from him/her or for adjudging him/her as an insolvent shall forthwith report the full facts of the legal proceedings to the Government.

Rule 28. Vindication of Acts and Character of Sevak

(1) No Sevak shall, except with the previous sanction of the Government, have recourse to any Court or to the Press for the vindication of any official act which has been the subject matter of adverse criticism or an attack of defamatory character.

(2) Nothing in this rule shall be deemed to prohibit any Sevak from vindicating his/her private character or any act done by him/her in his private capacity and where any action for indicating his/her private character or any act done by him/her in private capacity is taken, the Sevak shall submit a report to the Engaging Authority regarding such action.

Rule 29. Canvassing of Non-Official or Other Outside Influence

No Sevak shall bring or attempt to bring any political or other outside influence to bear upon any superior authority to further his/her interests in respect of matters pertaining to his/her engagement under the Government.

Rule 29-A. Prohibition Regarding Engaging in Any Business Detrimental to the Business of the Post Office/IPPB

The GDS will not engage in any activity with any outside agency which would be detrimental to the business or interest of the post office/IPPB.

Rule 30. Interpretation

If any question arises relating to the interpretation of these rules, it shall be referred to the Government whose decision thereon shall be final.

Rule 31. Delegation of Powers

The Government may, by general or special order, direct that any power exercisable by it under these rules (except the power under Rule 30 and this rule) shall, subject to such conditions, if any, as may be specified in the order, be exercisable also by such officer or authority as may be specified in the order.

Competent Authority in context of GDS

S.No.	Post	Engaging Authority	Disciplinary Authority	Appellate Authority	Revision Authority	Review Authority
1.	BPM	Divisional Head (Gr."A" JTS/STS / Gr. "B")	Sub Divisional Head (For Minor Penalty, 1-5 of Rule 9)	Divisional Head (Gr."A" JTS/STS / Gr. "B")	DPS	President
			Divisional Head (Gr."A" JTS/STS / Gr. "B") (For Minor & Major penalty, 1 to 9 of Rule-9)	DPS	PMG / CPMG	President
2.	ABPM	Sub-Divisional Head (ASP/IP)	Sub-Divisional Head (For Minor & Major Penalty, 1 to 9 of Rule-9)	Divisional Head (Gr."A" JTS/STS / Gr. "B")	DPS	President
3.	Dak Sevak	Sr.PM-Gr-"B" / ASP / ASRM / IP / IRM	Sr.PM-Gr."B" / ASP / ASRM / IP / IRM (For Minor & Major)	Divisional Head (Gr."A" JTS/STS / Gr. "B")	DPS	President

**Gramin Dak Sevak (GDS) – TRCA/Engagement/GDSGIS/SDBS/Transfer/Financial
Upgradation/Compassionate**

Implementation of Recommendations of One-Man Committee/Kamlesh Chandra Committee on Wages and Allowances of Gramin Dak Sevaks (GDSs)

Introduction of new Time Related Continuity Allowance (TRCA).

Table-1: Revised minimum TRCA of two types of categories of GDSs as per working hours / levels

Category	Minimum TRCA for 4 Hours / Level 1	Minimum TRCA for 5 Hours / Level 2
BPM	Rs. 12,000/-	Rs. 14,500/-
ABPM/DAK Sevak	Rs. 10,000/-	Rs. 12,000/-

Wage Scales

- **Wage Scale -1:** ABPM/Dak Sevak (Level-1) - Rs. 10,000/-
- **Wage Scale -2:** ABPM/Dak Sevak (Level-2) / BPM (Level-1) - Rs. 12,000/-
- **Wage Scale -3:** BPM (Level-2) - Rs. 14,500/-

Fixation formula: Multiplied by a factor of **2.57**.

Annual Increment: The annual increase of TRCA is **3%**.

In respect of the GDSs engaged on or after **01.07.2018**, the initial fixation will be done on the first stage of Level 1 of the respective category. There shall be two dates of annual increase in TRCA namely, **1st July** and **1st January** of every year; provided that a GDS shall be entitled to only one annual increase in TRCA on either one of these two dates depending on the date of engagement.

Productivity Linked Bonus

Present calculation of Ex-gratia bonus by applying the calculation ceiling of Rs. 7,000/- as basic TRCA + DA shall continue until further orders.

Date of Effect

The revised TRCA as per the matrix for all GDSs shall be applicable w.e.f. **01.07.2018**. The revised rate of other allowances shall also take effect from **01.07.2018**.

Allowances

1. Office Maintenance Allowance (OMA) / Composite Allowance (Only for BPM):

- For Standard accommodation - Rs. 500/- per month.
- For non-Standard accommodation - Rs. 250/- per month.

2. Fixed Stationary Charge: ABPM/Dak Sevak - Rs. 25/- per month.

3. Boat Allowance: Rs. 115/- per month.

4. Cash Conveyance Allowance: It is not a fixed allowance. Payable on incident basis:

- Up to **Rs. 1 Lakh**: Rs. 30/- + actual conveyance charges subject to maximum to fare of public bus.
- Above **Rs. 1 Lakh**: Rs. 50/- + actual conveyance charges subject to maximum to fare of public bus.

5. Cycle Maintenance Allowance: Rs. 180/- per month.

6. Combined Duty Allowance:

- BPM for Delivery or Mail Conveyance - Rs. 45/- per day subject to maximum Rs. 1,170/- per month ($45 * 26 = 1,170$).
- BPM for Delivery PLUS mail conveyance – **Rs. 90/-** per day subject to maximum **Rs. 2,340/-** per month ($90 * 26 = 2,340$).
- ABPM for BPM work – **Rs. 75/-** per day subject to maximum **1,950/-** per month ($75 * 26 = 1,950$).
- ABPM/GDS for additional work of ABPM/GDS – **Rs. 45/-** per day subject to maximum **Rs. 1,170/-** per month ($45 * 26 = 1,170$).

6. Risk & Hardship Allowance

Risk and Hardship allowance **Rs. 500/-** per month to the GDS working in areas which are identified for this allowance. (as identified by Government of India, as per 7th CPC recommendations).

Standard Accommodation

- **(a)** Building owned by Gram Panchayat.
- **(b)** Building owned by central government or by state government such as schools or offices.
- **(c)** BPM's own house.
- **(d)** Proper rented accommodation in a busy place of village.
- **(e)** Building owned by NGOs.
- **Location:** The GDS Post office should be located in the main busy part of the village.
- **Size:** The minimum size of GDS post office should be preferably in 10*10 dimensions and in ground floor not be less than **100 sq. Feet.**
- **Approach:** The Post office should have direct access/approach from village road and should be located in front portion of the building in which it is housed. The GDS post room/offices should not be housed in verandas, courtyards, Kitchen, under the stairs, bed damaged rooms, and makeshift arrangements, isolated building outside the village etc. which are difficult to access or approach by the customer.
- **Structure:** The GDS Post office accommodation should preferably be a Brick Mortar structure to ensure safety and security. The room should be properly ventilated and lighted and should be properly maintained and white washed.
- **Power supply:** The Post office room should have electrical power connection for charging of handheld devices and running fan, electricity bulb etc. and a suitable place to install solar panels.

- The accommodation for the GDS Post office should be exclusively available for post office use.
- It may work from a village shop but post office working from shop should have an exclusive space to keep the registers, micro ATMs and other items apart space for prominently exhibiting the signage etc. giving due importance to post office.

Children Education Facilitation Allowance for Gramin Dak Sevak

- The reimbursement of Children Education Facilitation Allowance can be claimed only for the two eldest surviving children with the exception that, in case the second child birth results in twin/multiple birth. In case of failure of sterilization operation, the Children Education Facilitation Allowance would be admissible in respect of children born out of the first instance of such failure beyond the usual two children norm.
- The amount of reimbursement of Children Education Facilitation Allowance will be **Rs. 6,000/-** per annum (fixed) per child. This amount of **Rs. 6,000/-** is fixed irrespective of the actual expenses incurred by the GDS.
- The reimbursement of children Education Facilitation Allowance shall have no nexus with the performance of the child in his/her class. In other words, even if a child fails in a particular class, the reimbursement of children Education Facilitation Allowance shall not be stopped. However, if the child is admitted in the same class in another school, although the child has passed out of the same class in previous school or mid-session, children Education Facilitation Allowance shall not be reimbursable.
- In case of discharge, dismissal or removal from engagement, children Education Facilitation Allowance shall be admissible till the end of the academic year in which the GDS ceases to be in engagement due to discharge, dismissal or removal from engagement in the course of an academic year.
- The upper age limit for Divyaang children has been set at **22 years**. In the case of other children, the age limit will be **20 years** or till the time of passing 12th class whichever is earlier. There shall be no minimum age.
- Reimbursement of Children Education Facilitation Allowance shall be applicable for children from class nursery to twelfth, including classes eleventh and twelfth

held by the junior Colleges or school affiliated to Universities or Boards of Education.

- Children Education Facilitation Allowance is allowed in case of children studying through "Correspondence or Distance Learning" subject to other conditions laid down in this OM.
- The Children Education Facilitation Allowance is admissible in respect of children studying from two classes before class one to 12th standard and also for the initial **two years** of a diploma/certificate course from Polytechnic/ITI/Engineering College, if the child pursues the course after passing 10th standard and the GDS has not been granted Children Education Facilitation Allowance in respect of the child for studies in 11th and 12th standards.
- In case of a Divyaang child studying in an institution i.e. aided or approved by the Central/state Govt. or UT Administration or whose fees are approved by any of these authorities, the Children Education Facilitation Allowance paid by the GDS shall be reimbursed irrespective of whether the institution is 'recognized' or not. In such cases the benefits will be admissible till the child attains the age of **22 years**.
- The children Education Facilitation Allowance shall be admissible to a GDS while he/she is on duty or is under put off duty or is on leave provided that during any period which is treated as 'non counted for duty', the GDS shall not be eligible for the children Education Facilitation Allowance for that period.

Emergency Leave

- Emergency leave will be granted for a maximum of **5 days** in a completed calendar year of the engagement period or proportionate thereof. The GDS will be paid TRCA as applicable during the period of emergency leave.
- Emergency leave will be granted to GDS to take care of any emergent/personal requirements. Not more than **two days** emergency leave will be granted at a time. No half day emergency leave will be granted. Emergency leave cannot be carried forward or enched or combined with paid leave.
- Sundays and Postal holidays falling during the period of emergency leave are not counted as part of emergency leave.

- Prior Sanction is required:
 - For BPM - Divisional Head
 - For ABPM/GDS - Sub Division Head/Sr. PM/Unit Head
 - Unit Head As per OM dated **16.09.2025** full power to grant leave to GDS by SPM/PM (LSG/HSG-II,HSG-I,NFG)
- No full-time substitute will be engaged against the resultant vacancy and duty work of BO should be combined of duties except in case of single hand BO.
- Emergency leave will not be granted to GDS who are under put off duty.
- When a GDS stays beyond **two days** emergency leave at a time, the whole period shall be debited against his/her paid leave account due. In case he/she is not having paid leave the period in excess of such leave due will be treated as unauthorized absence and the GDS shall not be entitled to any TRCA.

Paid Leave

- The Gramin Dak Sevaks may be granted paid leave at the rate of **20 days** in a year (**10 days** for every half year) without accumulation or as may be determined by the Government, from time to time.
- Prior Sanction is required:
 - **(a)** For BPM - Divisional Head;
 - **(b)** For ABPM/GDS - Sub Division Head/Sr. PM/Unit Head.
 - Unit Head As per OM dated **16.09.2025** full power to grant leave to GDS by SPM/PM (LSG/HSG-II,HSG-I,NFG).

Gramin Dak Sevak Group Insurance Scheme 2010

- Insurance Amount - Rs. 50,000/-
- Premium - Rs. 50/- per month
- From **1st Oct 2021**, the subscription of **Rs. 50/-** comprises a Savings fund of **Rs. 32.50** & Insurance Fund of Rs. 17.50 (Ratio **65:35**).
- Age - **19 to 50 Years**.
- After retirement, the subscription with interest will be payable to the GDS. In case of death/suicide, the amount of Rs. 50,000/- will be payable to the nominee.

Leave Without Allowance (LWA)

- Gramin Dak Sevaks (GDS), not being regular employees of the Govt of India, are not covered under the Central Civil Services (Leave) Rules 1972.
- GDS are entitled to Leave Without Allowance. No allowance is payable for the period of leave.
- LWA is in addition to other kinds of leave to GDS (Paid leave, Emergency Leave and Maternity Leave to female GDS).

S.No.	Category of GDS	Period of LWA in days in a Year	Sanctioning Authority
1	Branch Postmaster	60 days	Sub Divisional Head
2	Branch Postmaster	> 60 & < 180 days	Divisional Head
3	Assistant Branch Postmaster / Dak Sevaks	90 days	Sub Divisional Head or Head of the office if the GDS works in an Office which is an Appointing Unit
4	ABPM / Dak Sevaks	> 90 & < 180 days	Divisional Head
5	All GDS	Beyond 180 days	Regional PMG/DPS

Limited Transfer Facility (LTF)

Conditions of Transfer

- The minimum engagement condition for transfer of GDS under LTF is revised from 'one year' to '**TWO YEARS OF CONTINUOUS ENGAGEMENT**'. It implies that a GDS should have completed minimum continuous engagement of a period of **TWO (2) years** from the date of regular engagement as GDS on the last date fixed for submission of online application in a particular cycle will be eligible to seek transfer under the LTF.
- The GDS may apply for transfer against any or all of the vacant posts of GDS, as per their eligibility, in order of preference, in any one of the Divisions at a time. The transfer will be at the own cost of GDS.
- The online request for transfer may be submitted, as and when the window for GDS online transfer is made open from time to time. Generally, the schedule for GDS online transfer cycle will be issued on a half-yearly basis, immediately before the GDS Online Engagement Cycles.
- Refusal to accept the Limited Transfer Order shall be counted as **one** chance of Limited Transfer availed by GDS. If application of transfer is to be withdraw by GDS within window period available, In this situation the chance shall not be counted as chance availed under the Limited Transfer Facility.
- Mutual Exchange facility can be provided to all GDS on completion of **1 (ONE) year** for all GDS from the date of regular engagement on GDS.
- The male GDS will be provided **Two** chances to avail LTF during the entire career. The female GDS will get **THREE** chances under the facility. However, there will be a 'cooling off' period of **one year** of continuous engagement between two successive transfers.
- Transfer request of GDS who are under put off duty or against whom any disciplinary action, Police case or Court case is pending will not be entertained.
- Past engagement period will be counted for assessing the eligibility for appearing in departmental examination as well as for annual increment. GDS will not have

any claim to go back to the previous engagement/recruitment Unit/Division in any circumstances.

- When a GDS is transferred at his own request and the transfer is approved by the competent authority, she/he will rank junior in the seniority list of the new unit, to all the GDS of that unit who exist in the seniority List on the date on which the transfer is ordered, except in case of transfer within the same engagement/recruitment Sub Division/Unit/ Division.

Permitted Level Transfers

The GDS can be transferred on her/his request in following circumstances:

S/No	Level of GDS	Transfer allowed (level of GDS)
1	BPM Level-1	(a) BPM Level-1 in TRCA Slab-2 (b) ABPM/DAK Sevak Level-2 (Postal/RMS) in same TRCA Slab
2	BPM Level-2	BPM Level-2 in TRCA Slab-3
3	ABPM/DAK Sevak Level-1	ABPM/DAK Sevak Level-1 in TRCA Slab-1
4	ABPM/DAK Sevak Level-2	(a) ABPM/DAK Sevak Level-2 in TRCA Slab-2 (b) BPM Level-1 in same TRCA slab-2 provided that: * GDS has to make standard accommodation arrangement for managing BO * Fulfill the educational qualification and having adequate knowledge to operate computer/ desktop/ PoS/ Mobile * Before joining as BPM Level-1 he/she has to undergo prescribed training for BPM
5	ABPM/DAK Sevak	ABPM/DAK Sevak from Postal to RMS and vice versa in same TRCA slab

6	Dak Sevak in RMS	BPM/ABPM/Dak Sevak in the same TRCA level. If he/she join as BPM the following condition shall be fulfilled: * GDS has to make standard accommodation arrangement for managing BO * Fulfill the educational qualification and having adequate knowledge to operate computer/ desktop/ PoS/ Mobile * Before joining as BPM Level-1 he/she has to undergo prescribed training for BPM
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- There will not be any drop in TRCA slab on account of a request transfer and numbers of increments earned by GDS will be retained.
- The division head will obtain vigilance clearance/engagement particular from head of current engagement unit after receiving of application of transfer from GDS.
- The inter-se seniority of two or more GDS upon transfer to same Sub Division/Division in the same cycle of transfer would be decided on the basis of their date of joining in the Department, i.e., the GDS joining earlier in the Department would rank senior to GDS, who joined later.
- Transfer request for GDS vacant posts should not be considered if such vacant posts have already been notified for GDS engagement. If such posts which remains vacant after exhausting of prescribed panel, may be considered for accommodating transfer request.

Order of Priority

In case of receipt of two or more application for transfer on a same post, the order of priority in which transfer application will be processed in online mode, will be as under:

- **(i)** GDS with PwD (having benchmark disabilities)
- **(ii)** Female GDS - on spouse ground where male spouse is working at the destination station in Central/State Government or their undertaking/PSU/Subordinate organizations etc. (Certificate to this effect will have to be submitted)

- **(iii)** Male GDS- on spouse ground where female spouse is working at the destination station (having job of non-transferable nature in Central/State Government or their undertaking/PSU/Subordinate organizations etc.) (Certificate to this effect will have to be submitted)
- **(iv)** Date of engagement (GDS joining on a prior date will have preference over the GDS joining on a later date)
- **(v)** Female (other than spouse ground)
- **(vi)** Date of birth (older in age to be given preference) and
- **(vii)** Date & time of application (applicant submitting application at a prior date & time will have preference over the applicant who submitted application later)

Transfer on Vigilance Ground

- GDS revoked from put off duty, should not ordinarily be posted on the same post and should be transferred to any other vacant post.
- GDS against whom there are regular complaints substantiated by documentary evidence should be considered for transfer under vigilance ground.

Transfer on Administrative Ground

- Non-improvement in delivery of services rendered by Department to member of public by a GDS supported by documentary evidence. Before applying this condition, engaging authority shall ensure that, sufficient opportunity has been given in writing to GDS to improve.
- Abolition of post being held by GDS due to closure of office redeployment of post. Under this condition to the extent feasible, GDS shall be transferred to a place/office after taking into consideration the preference given by the GDS in writing.

Condition of Transfer of GDS

- **(i)** BPM Level-2 to BPM Level-2 in TRCA slab-3.
- **(ii)** BPM Level-1 to BPM Level-1 in TRCA slab-2.

- **(iii)** ABPM/Dak Sevaks Level-2 to ABPM/Dak Sevaks Level-2 in TRCA slab-2.
- **(iv)** ABPM/Dak Sevaks Level-1 to ABPM/Dak Sevaks Level-1 in TRCA slab-1.
- **(v)** BPM Level-1 to ABPM/Dak Sevak Level-2 in TRCA slab-2.
- **(v)-a** ABPM/Dak Sevak (Level-2) to BPM (Level-1) in TRCA slab-2
- **(v)-b** Dak Sevak in RMS units to BPM/ABPM/Dak Sevak in Postal units in same TRCA Slab
- **(v)-c** BPM/ABPM/Dak Sevak in Postal units to Dak Sevak in RMS units in Same TRCA slab.

Note - ABPM/Dak Sevak/Dak Sevak in RMS to BPM (Level-1) under the above provision shall be permitted only on administrative ground and not on vigilance ground.

- There will not be any drop in TRCA slab on account of transfer and number of increments earned by GDS will be retained if no such penalty has been awarded to GDS.
- in order to avoid long dislocation, GDS may be transferred within jurisdiction of Sub Division to the extent possible, otherwise within Division or within region.
- While transferring GDS BPM Level 2, it may be ensured that, GDS BPM is transferred to the BO in level 2 which is located in Gram Panchayat Accommodation, Building owned by Central Govt. or by State Government such as Schools or Offices as far as practicable.

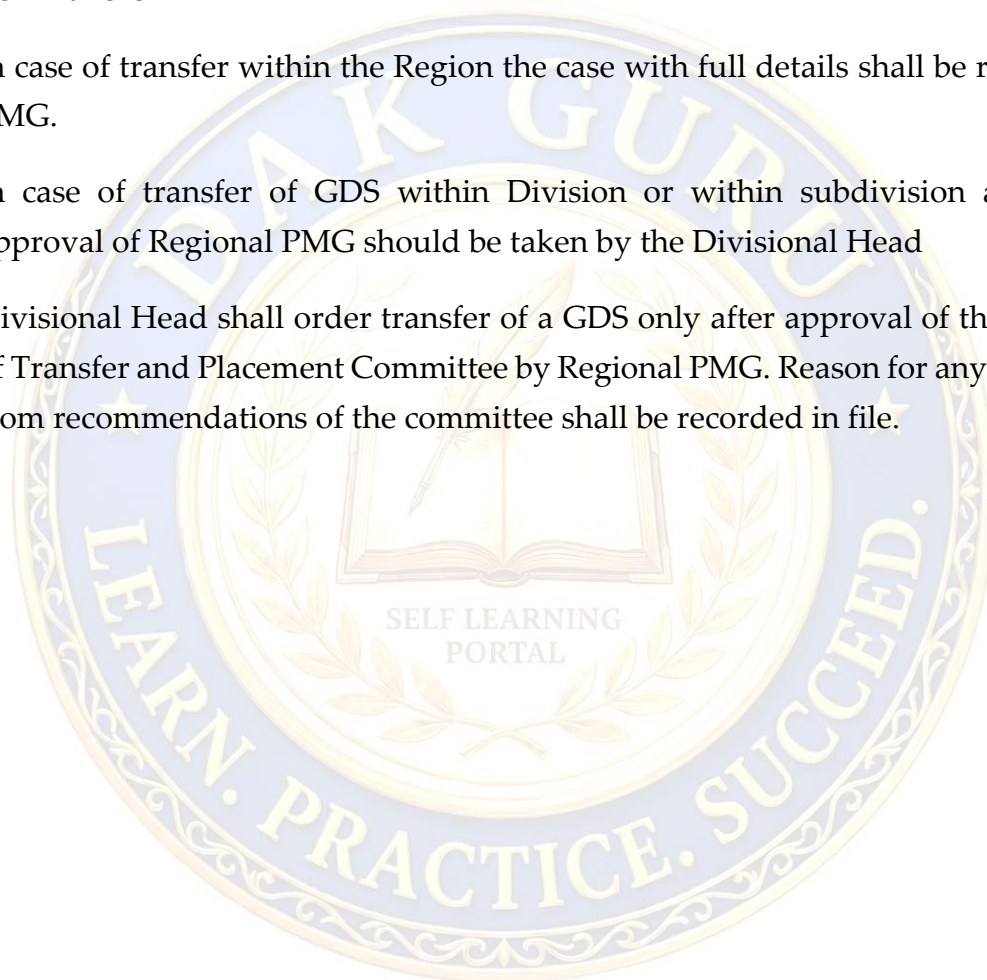
Committee for Transfer and Placement

- Transfer within a Sub Division shall be considered by a committee comprising Head of Division, ASP (HQ)/Office Superintendent of Divisional office and concerned Sub Divisional head.
- Transfer within the Division shall be considered by a committee comprising Head of Division, ASP (HQ)/Office Superintendent of Divisional office and concerned Sub Divisional heads of both the Sub Division where GDS is working and where he/she is being transferred.

- Transfer within the Region shall be considered by a committee comprising Divisional Heads of both the Divisions, Sub Divisional head concerned and another Sub Divisional head of the concerned Division.
- Committee shall not recommend transfer of a GDS on administrative / vigilance grounds, to a post to which request of the GDS is pending under Limited Transfer facility available to them.

Process of Transfer

- In case of transfer within the Region the case with full details shall be referred to PMG.
- In case of transfer of GDS within Division or within subdivision also prior approval of Regional PMG should be taken by the Divisional Head
- Divisional Head shall order transfer of a GDS only after approval of the minutes of Transfer and Placement Committee by Regional PMG. Reason for any deviation from recommendations of the committee shall be recorded in file.



GDS Gratuity and Severance Amount

S.No.	Scheme	Existing Benefits	Revised Benefits
1	GDS Gratuity (Earlier called Ex-gratia Gratuity)	Granted at the rate of half month's basic TRCA drawn immediately before discharge of service, for each completed year of service subject to a maximum of Rs.60,000/- or 16.5 times basic TRCA last drawn, whichever is less.	Continuation of the existing formula for grant of GDS Gratuity (earlier Ex-gratia Gratuity) subject to a maximum of Rupees one lakh fifty thousand (Rs.1,50,000/-) w.e.f. 01.01.2016. Minimum Service – 10 Years required.
2	Severance Amount	Rs.1500/- per completed year, maximum Rs.60,000/- subject to a GDS having completed 10 years of continuous service.	Rs.4000/- per completed year, maximum Rupees one lakh fifty thousand (Rs.1,50,000) subject to a GDS having completed 10 years of continuous service w.e.f. 01.01.2016. Severance amount is applicable only to those GDS who opted to remain with Severance amount and have not shifted to SDBS. Minimum Service – 10 Years required.

Note: 6 months and above will be counted as **one year** and less than 6 months are ignored only in calculation of total years in GDS Gratuity or Severance Amount.

Old Rate for Severance Amount (01.10.2009)

Nature of benefit	Present benefit	Revised Benefits
Ex-gratia gratuity	Granted at the rate of half months basic TRCA drawn immediately before discharge of service for each completed year of service subject to a maximum of Rs. 18,000/- or 16.5 months basic TRCA last drawn whichever is less. Minimum service prescribed is 15 years .	Continuance of existing formula for grant of ex-gratia gratuity subject of maximum of Rs. 60,000/- .
Severance amount	A lump sum severance amount of Rs. 30,000/- is paid on discharge provided a GDS has completed 20 years of continuous service. In case of a GDS completing 15 years of but less than 20 years of continuous service the severance amount paid is Rs. 20,000/- .	Severance amount shall be at the rate of Rs. 1,500/- for every completed year of the service subject to a maximum of Rs. 60,000/- with reduction in minimum eligibility period to 10 years .

Provisions regarding Gratuity, Severance, and SDBS Migration

1. If an existing GDS remains with Severance amount instead of opting SDBS, 2011 and promotes in MTS/PM/MG/PA/SA, the amount of Severance will be paid him into the cash if he completes **10 years** of continuation of engagement. As per latest clarification from Directorate vide order Number 17-31/2016-GDS dated **26.11.2024** "the GDS who are absorbed on a regular post in Department is not eligible for Gratuity".
2. If an existing GDS joined into SDBS, 2011 and promotes in MTS/PM/MG/PA/SA, Total accumulated Pension Corpus of SDBS, 2011 with severance amount will be credited into NPS Tier-1 due to migrate from SDBS to NPS.

3. If an existing GDS joined into SDBS, 2011, and if the engagement period is less than **10 years**. In case he promotes in MTS/PM/MG/PA/SA. The Total accumulated Pension Corpus of SDBS, 2011 with Severance amount will be credited into NPS Tier-1 due to migrate from SDBS to NPS.
4. In the case of death of GDS, the Severance amount and Gratuity will be paid to nominee if the GDS has completed the **10 years** of continuation engagement. If he joined SDBS, 2011, the accumulated fund will be paid to spouse/nominee as per rules of exit of NPS-Lite.
5. In the case of death of GDS, the Severance amount and Gratuity will not be paid to nominee if the GDS has not completed the **10 years** of continuation engagement. If he joined SDBS, 2011, the accumulated fund will be paid to spouse/nominee as per rules of exit of NPS-Lite.
6. **6 months** and above will be counted as **one year** and less than **6 months** are ignored in calculation of years in GDS Gratuity or Severance Amount.

Voluntary Discharge Scheme for GDS

Scheme-1: On Completion of 20 Years of Period

- **Minimum qualifying engagement period: 20 Years**
- **Age:** No age restriction
- **Notice Period: 3 months**
- Request can be withdrawn prior to acceptance of notice, with the approval of the accepting Authority i.e. Divisional Head.
- The Divisional Head will be the competent authority to accept and approve the all-voluntary discharge for all categories of GDS.
- Compassionate engagement will not be available for the dependent of the GDS to be discharged voluntarily.
- **Entitlements:** Normal discharge benefits proportionate to the period of engagement rendered. In case the GDS quits engagement before completion of **20**

years of engagement period, he/she will not be entitled to get any monetary benefits under the scheme.

Scheme-2: On Medical Ground

Scope: Intended for those who suffer on account of any contagious disease or bodily or mental infirmity, which permanently incapacitates him/her for engagement.

Option (A)

In Case a GDS who suffer on account of any contagious disease or bodily or mental infirmity, which permanently incapacitates him/her for engagement and does not wish to quit prematurely. The following provision shall be applicable:

No authority shall dispense with or reduce TRCA of a GDS who suffers on account of any contagious disease or bodily or mental infirmity, which permanently incapacitates him/her for engagement:

Provided that, if a GDS after acquiring disability is not suitable for the post he/she was holding, shall be shifted to some other post, irrespective of its TRCA level, which is suitable for discharge of his or her duties as GDS.

Provided further that if it is not possible to adjust the GDS against any post keeping in view the nature of disability, he/she may be kept on a supernumerary post until a suitable post is available or he/she attains the age of **65 years**, whichever is earlier.

Option (B)

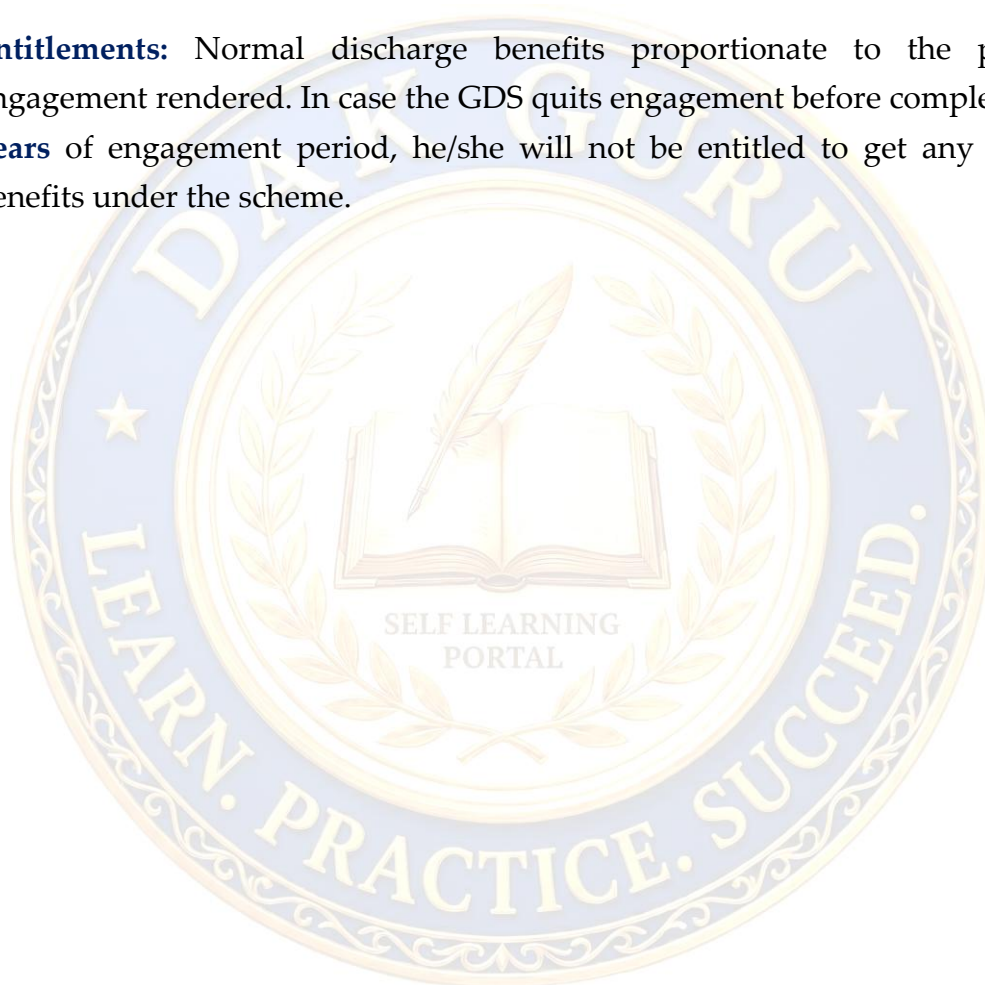
In Case a GDS who suffer on account of any contagious disease or bodily or mental infirmity, which permanently incapacitates him/her for engagement and neither willing to be shifted on any other post nor to be retained on the supernumerary post, he/she may quit Gramin Dak Seva (in short Seva) permanently. The following provision shall be applicable - Terms & Conditions:

- **(i)** An application for quitting the Seva in prescribed proforma will be submitted by the GDS.
- **(ii)** In case GDS is not in a position to sign the application, it can be submitted on his behalf by his/her spouse or any other family member, above **18 years** of age.

- **(iii)** On submission of application, the GDS is to be directed by the Divisional Head (not the below rank of PSs Group B) to appear before the appropriate Medical Authority (i.e., Civil Surgeon or a District Medical Officer or Medical Officer of Govt. Hospital) immediately but not later than **15 days** from receipt of his/her application for quitting the seva.
- **(iv)** Upon being referred by the Divisional Head, the appropriate Medical Authority, who will examine the fitness of the GDS and in case he is found to be fit he will certify accordingly. In case the GDS is not found fit, the Medical Authority would certify that:
 - a. the GDS suffer on account of any contagious disease (name of disease) or bodily or mental infirmity (name of infirmity) which permanently incapacitates him/her for engagement as GDS.
 - OR
 - b. the GDS is fit for further service of less laborious character than he is presently doing.
- **(v)** A certificate so obtained from the Medical Authority without the prior approval of the Department will not be valid.
- **(vi)** Where the medical authority has found the GDS fit for further service or fit for the work of less laborious character, the GDS will not be allowed to quit and he/she will be offered alternative post. In case the Medical Authority certify him to be unfit, the competent authority will accept the request forthwith.
- **(vii)** The Divisional Head will be the competent authority to accept and approve the voluntary discharge for all categories of GDS. Date of effect will be the date of acceptance of the request.
- **(viii)** The scheme is purely voluntary and there will be no compulsion on any GDS to quit under this scheme.
- **(ix)** The scheme will not be available for GDS under put off duty, or against whom any disciplinary action/criminal action is pending or contemplated.
- **(x)** The scheme will be effective from the date of issue of this O.M. and applicable to all the GDS who are engaged on regular basis in accordance with the GDS

(Conduct & Engagement) Rules, as amended time to time, subject to fulfillment of all other conditions of this scheme.

- **Minimum qualifying engagement period: 10 Years**
- **Age:** No age restriction
- Compassionate engagement will not be available for the dependent of the GDS to be discharged voluntarily.
- **Entitlements:** Normal discharge benefits proportionate to the period of engagement rendered. In case the GDS quits engagement before completion of **10 years** of engagement period, he/she will not be entitled to get any monetary benefits under the scheme.



Service Discharge Benefit Scheme (SDBS), 2011

- GDS Committee headed by Shri. R S Natrajan Murti recommended introduction of SDBS in place of existing Severance Amount Scheme.
- Came into existence - **01.04.2011**
- The scheme shall utilize the platform of NPS-Lite scheme for the purpose of registration, record keeping, fund management etc.

Definitions

- **(a) Aggregator cum Account Officer:** GM Finance (Postal accounts and Finance) or Director of Accounts (Postal).
- **(b) Collection Centre (CC):** An office of Director, Sr. Supdt./Supdt. /Head of Postal Division.
- **(c) Custodian:** Means a company/agency, responsible for holding assets of the NPS Trust; At present, the Deutsche Bank AG is the Custodian on behalf of the NPS Trust.
- **(d) Oversight Offices:** Office of Director General, Department of Posts, India, New Delhi.
- **(e) PFRDA:** Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority of India.

Eligibility

- **(a)** All existing regular engaged Gramin Dak Sevak who has been selected after due process in accordance with Gramin Dak Sevak (Conduct and Employment) Rules, 2020 and rendered at least **one-year** satisfactory service are eligible to join the scheme. Subscription for the SDBS begins only after the completion of **one year** from the date of joining.
- **(b)** The existing GDS who are due to be discharged from service within **3 years** as on **01 January 2011**, shall not be eligible to join the scheme.
- **(c)** The scheme shall be mandatorily applicable to all GDS, engaged on a regular basis under the prescribed GDS (Conduct & Employment), 2020 on after introduction of the scheme on completing **one year** of satisfactory service.

- **(d)** The existing GDS opting to continue to remain under the Severance Amount Scheme, shall continue to be subject the existing term and condition of the scheme, without any linkage whatsoever to the SDBS.
- **(e)** In case the GDS, opting to join SDBS, the amount accrued since the date of joining the scheme @ **Rs. 1,500/-** for every completed year of service till the enrolment under SDBS will be added to the accumulated contribution in their Permanent Retirement Account at the time of Discharge from Service/Death for annuitization/utilization.
- **(f)** The amount of severance amount for the period of less than a year shall be calculated for the complete month on proportionate basis. The fraction period of less than **15 days** shall be ignored, while the period **15 days** or more than **15 days** shall be treated a complete month for the purpose.

Subscription

- **(a)** The Govt. Of India, Dept of Posts shall subscribe @ **Rs. 300/-** per month and the same amount shall be contributed by GDS also w.e.f. **01.07.2018**.

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** Substituted for "Rs. 200/- per month" (Government contribution only) to an equal contribution of Rs. 300/- from both Govt. and GDS w.e.f. 01.07.2018. (Updated 2025).

- **(b)** No contribution/subscription shall be made by department in respect of GDS during the period they are placed on "Put of duty" or remain unauthorized absence.

Appointment/Permanent Absorption of a GDS in a Regular Departmental Post

After such incident, the scheme must be quite and all accrued accumulation with any severance amount shall be transferred into new account under the National Pension System.

Exit from SDBS

- **(a) At the age (65 years) of normal discharge from service:**
 - For Lump sum withdrawal - **60%**
 - For purchase of annuity - **40%**
- **(b) Premature exit "After the age of 58 years and before 65 years":**
 - For Lump sum withdrawal - **20%**
 - For purchase of annuity - **80%**
- **(c) Resignation from Service:** Pension Retirement Account of SDBS shall be treated as closed in this event.
 - For Lump sum withdrawal - **15%**
 - For purchase of annuity - **85%**
- **(d) Dismissal and Removal from Service:** The PR account shall be treated as closed and all accrued accumulation shall also forfeit.

Payment of Various Charges

All the charges will be borne by department.

Gramin Dak Sevaks (Grant of Financial Upgradation) Scheme, 2024

1. Title

This scheme is called Gramin Dak Sevaks (Grant of Financial Upgradation) Scheme, 2024.

2. Date of Effect

Come into the force - **15.03.2024**

3. Applicability:

The scheme shall be applicable to all GDS engaged on regular basis in accordance with the GDS (Conduct & Engagement) Rules as amended time to time.

4. Benefit under the GDSFU:

- **a.** The GDSs will get a fixed addition of **Rs. 360/-**, **Rs. 460/-** and **Rs. 600/-** per month on completion of **12**, **24** and **36 years** of "continuous engagement". This fixed amount is in addition to the TRCA being drawn. Dearness Allowance will not be paid on this fixed addition and this will also not count for grant of annual increase of TRCA.
- **Explanation:** At the time of introduction of the scheme, the fixed addition to the TRCA will be as under:
 - **a)** The GDS who have completed **12 years** of continuous engagement or more (but less than **24 years**) will be entitled for a fixed addition of **Rs. 360/-** per month.
 - **b)** The GDS who have completed **24 years** of continuous engagement or more (but less than **36 years**) will be entitled for a fixed addition of **Rs. 820/-** (i.e. **Rs. 360 + 460**) per month.
 - **c)** The GDS who have completed **36 years** of continuous engagement or more will be entitled for a fixed addition of **Rs. 1,420/-** (i.e. **Rs. 360 + 460 + 600**) per month.

5. Continuous Engagement:

- **a.** In determining the period of continuous engagement, following periods will be treated as break in engagement unless condoned by the competent authority:
 - **i.** Unauthorized absence
 - **ii.** Put off Duty Period
- **b.** In case of condonation of period of absence/put off duty by the competent authority, the interruption so arising on this account will not be construed as break in the continuous engagement (leading of past service); however, the condoned period will not be counted towards determining the length of continuous engagement.
- **c.** In case of provisional engagement which is followed by regular engagement after completion of prescribed formalities/verification of documents, the date of engagement will be taken as the date of joining on the basis of issue of the order of provisional engagement.

6. Screening committee:

- **a. Members:**
 - **i. 3 Members - Dy. SP/ASP (HQ)/ Inspector**

Activity	Maturing Cases during first half year (Jan to June)	Maturing during second half year (July to Dec)
Identification of eligible GDS and preparation of Special Report by Sub Divisional Head/Unit Incharge (LSG and above)	1st April to 10th June	1st Oct to 10th Dec
Submission of list of eligible GDS along with Special Report by Sub Divisional Head/Unit Incharge (LSG and above) to Divisional Head/Unit Head	15th June	15th Dec

Meeting of Screening Committee	1st week of July	1st week of January
Issue of Order	15th of July	15th January

7. Schedule:

- **a.** The committee shall meet twice a year i.e. **first week of January & July**. The order will be issued on **15th of January** and **15th of July**.
- **b.** The orders for grant of the financial upgradation by the division/unit head will be issued by **31st January/31st July** as the case may be.

8. Guidelines for the Screening Committee:

- **a.** While considering the case of financial upgradation, the committee shall not recommend the benefits under the scheme in the following circumstances:
 - **i.** Pendency of disciplinary/criminal proceedings
 - **ii.** Put off duty
 - **iii.** Currency of any minor/major penalty other than "censure"

9. Representation:

- **a.** The GDS who is aggrieved with the decision of the screening committee/divisional head regarding non grant of the financial upgradation would be entitled to submit representation to the next higher authority i.e. DPS/DPS(HQ)/PMG/CPMG within a period of **3 months** from such rejection.

10. GDS working on Departmental Posts/APS/IPPB etc.

- **a.** The GDS working on Departmental Posts/APS/IPPB etc shall also be eligible for grant of benefits under the scheme from the due date of completion of requisite period of engagement. Their cases will also be considered by the screening committee in regular course along with other cases. However, the addition to the TRCA will only be allowed once they are repatriated to their original/alternative post of GDS. No arrear of benefits accrued will be paid in such cases.

Substitute Arrangement in place of Regular GDS

Short Term Vacancies	Long Term Vacancies
Vacancies arising due to leave, medical condition of GDS etc up to 45 days shall be treated as Short Term Vacancies.	Vacancies of more than 45 days caused due to any circumstances including deputation, discharge, termination etc.
Substitute should not be engaged against a Short-Term Vacancies in any GDS posts in routine manner. As far as the work should be managed by combining duties.	Combination of duties may be restored and Substitute may be allowed only if workload of the BO as well as its financial position/revenue norms justifies such engagement of filling of the post at BO on regular basis.
When combination of duty (stop-gap arrangement) is not possible, then only substitute may be provided not more than 45 days against any GDS post. The Sub Division Head (SDH) will be authorized to approve substitute arrangements for BPM /ABPM/ Dak Sewak working in the sub-Division up to a period of 45 days .	Continuation of substitute arrangements beyond 45 days and up to a period of one year at a stretch may only be allowed by the Divisional Head. A record of such arrangements will be maintained in the Divisional Office, mentioning the justification of the continuation of such arrangements.

During the inspection of the Division, each case of substitute arrangement beyond **180 days** will be reviewed by the Inspecting Authority, with specific reference to the efforts made to fill the post through regular means. If any arrangement is found unjustified, the Inspecting Authority shall record its observations and refer the matter for the necessary orders of the Regional PMG/CPMG.

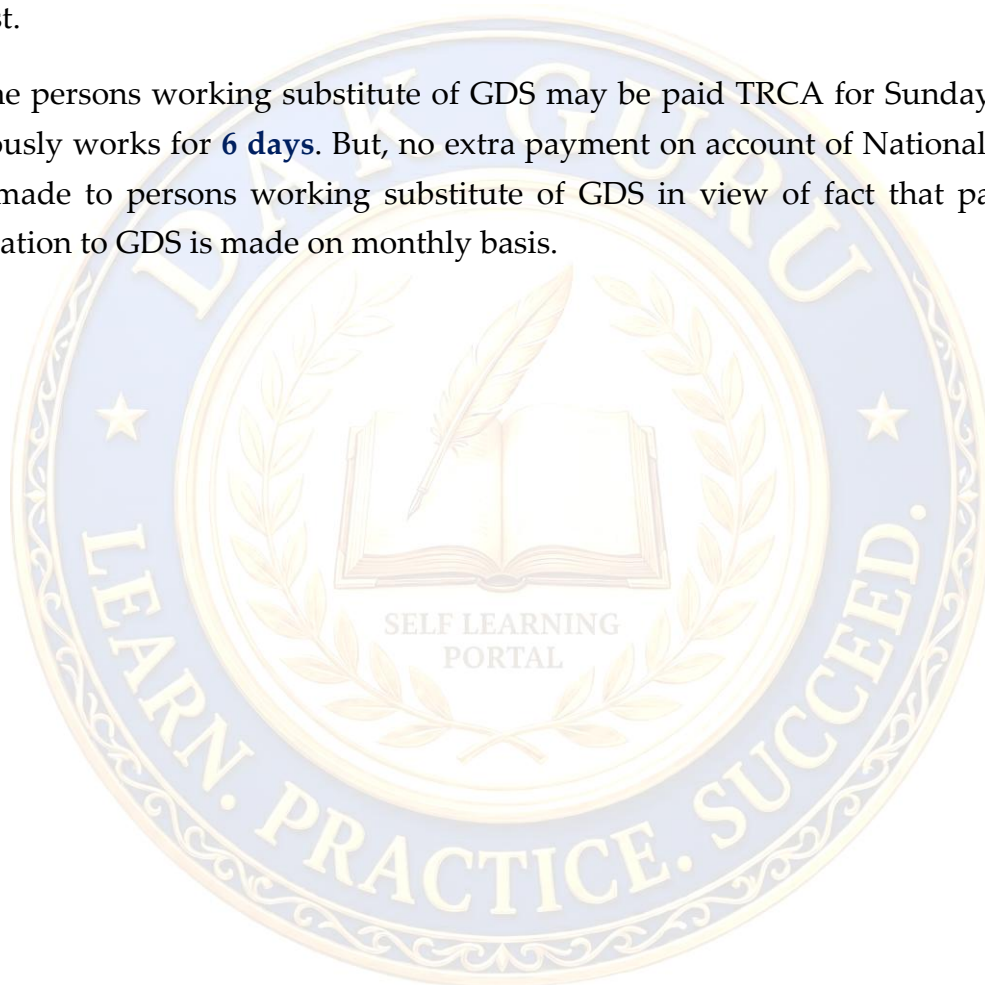
On receipt of such reference, Regional PMG/CPMG would issue necessary directions for continuation of such arrangement or otherwise within a **fortnight**.

No substitute arrangement against any vacant GDS post shall be allowed to continue beyond **one year** without the specific approval of the Head of Region (HoR) or Head of Circle (HoC), as the case may be. For continuation of such arrangement beyond **one year**, the Divisional Head shall submit a detailed proposal to the competent authority at least

one month in advance of the completion of the **one-year** period, clearly justifying the need for further continuation. In the event that no communication (approval or observations) is received from the HoR/HoC within the stipulated time, the approval shall be deemed to have been granted.

Practice of giving break for a **few days** and then again providing substitute for the same vacant GDS post is not proper. The number of days for which a substitute is engaged shall be counted from the first day when a substitute was provided against the vacant GDS post.

Note: The persons working substitute of GDS may be paid TRCA for Sunday if he/she continuously works for **6 days**. But, no extra payment on account of National Holidays will be made to persons working substitute of GDS in view of fact that payment of remuneration to GDS is made on monthly basis.



GDS (Compassionate Engagement) Scheme 2023

Objective

The objective of the Scheme is to grant engagement on compassionate grounds to one of dependent family members of regularly engaged GDS/departmental employees, to relieve the family of the such GDS/employee from financial destitution and to help it to get over the emergency.

Compassionate engagement may be granted in the following cases:

- **i)** If the GDS or departmental employee passes away while in service or has been missing for more than **two years**.
- **ii)** If the GDS or departmental employee is compelled to permanently leave Gramin Dak Seva/service due to a contagious disease or a physical/mental infirmity that renders them permanently unfit for engagement, provided GDS is discharge on these medical grounds before attaining the age of **62 years**.

Compassionate engagement would not be a matter of right and it will be subject to fulfillment of all the conditions, including availability of vacancy, as laid down for such engagement under the scheme.

Note:

- **i)** Only one eligible dependent of the deceased GDS/departmental employee would be entitled to compassionate engagement as GDS.
- **ii)** In case of departmental employee, one and the same eligible dependent may apply for appointment on compassionate grounds on both, departmental vacancy and against GDS vacancy as per the eligibility criteria and conditions prescribed under the relevant schemes for compassionate appointment/engagement. In case of selection against both, on GDS as well as departmental posts, the candidate will have to choice to select engagement/appointment on any one of the post and will have to quit/resign from the other post on permanent basis.
- **iii)** GDS discharged on account of any contagious disease or bodily or mental infirmity: Cases of Gramin Dak Sevaks who is allowed to quit as GDS permanently in accordance with the provisions of the Scheme of Voluntary Discharge on account of any contagious disease or bodily or mental infirmity which

permanently incapacitates him/her for engagement as GDS, are also covered in under the scheme for compassionate engagement provided the GDS is discharged on these medical grounds before attaining the age of **62 years** and subject to fulfilling other conditions as mentioned in the OM No. 19-19/2024-GDS dated **25.02.2025** (as revised from time to time on Voluntary Discharge Scheme for Gramin Dak Sevaks on Medical Grounds).

Who can apply?

A dependent family member of GDS engaged on regular basis who dies while in engagement (including death by suicide):

"Dependent Family Member" means and includes the following:

- **(a)** Spouse;
- **(b)** Son including legally adopted son/married son;
- **(c)** Daughter including legally adopted daughter/divorced daughter/Judicially separated daughter wholly dependent on the GDS;
- **(d)** In the case of death of an unmarried GDS, unmarried brother or sister (unmarried, /widow/divorced/judicially separated) wholly dependent on the GDS at the time of his/her death;
- **(e)** Widowed daughter-in-law of the deceased GDS, provided she gives an undertaking that she is not availing the same benefit from her own parenthood;
- **(f)** Widowed daughter of the GDS, provided she gives an undertaking that she is not availing the same benefit from her husband's parenthood.

Note: A widow/divorced daughter or sister engaged on compassionate grounds will be allowed to continue in engagement even after re-marriage.

Order of Priority

- **(i)** First priority will be given to spouse of the deceased GDS. In such cases consent of the spouse will only be taken.
- **(ii)** Second priority will be given to the dependent nominated by spouse. In such cases the consent of the spouse and the nominated dependent will only be taken.

- **(iii)** In case there is no spouse or GDS was unmarried at the time of his/her death, the compassionate engagement may be given to any one of the dependent family members with the consent of all other dependents.

Authority Competent to Make Compassionate Engagement and Periodicity of Meeting of CCE

- **(i)** Divisional Head/Head of Unit (PSs Group B and above) will be competent to make Compassionate engagements on the vacant GDS posts, on the basis of recommendations of the Committee on Compassionate Engagement (CCE) and prior approval of Regional Director or DPS [HQ] as the case may be.
- **(ii)** All cases for compassionate engagement will be considered by a CCE and recommendations of the Committee will be sent for approval of Regional Director or to DPS [HQ] where the Division/Unit report directly to Circle Office.
- **(iii)** The CCE will consist of **3 members** for considering compassionate engagement of dependent of deceased GDS as under:
 - **(a)** Head of engaging Division/Unit PSs Group B and above
 - **(b)** In case of Division:
 - **(1)** Dy. SP/ASP/IP posted in Divisional Office who looks after compassionate engagement cases in the Division
 - **(2)** Senior most sub divisional head of the Division concerned.
 - **(c)** In case of Units, one ASP/IP looking after compassionate engagement cases in the Unit and one senior most ASP/IP working in the Unit. In case of non-availability of ASP/IP in the unit, ASP/IP posted at the same station in other units/divisions may be coopted.

The Committee will meet quarterly, i.e., in April, July, October and January to consider the cases arising during the previous quarter.

Information along with necessary documents to family of the deceased GDS	Submission of application by the SDI to Divisional Head	Application received in quarter	Completion of Applications in all respect, received by Divisional Head	CCE Meeting to be conducted and Minutes sent to RO/DPS (HQ) for approval by DPS latest by
Immediately after the death of GDS not later than 7 days of the death of the GDS	within 25 days of the death of GDS	January to March	April	15th May
		April to June	July	15th August
		July to September	October	15th November
		October to December	January	15th February

Note: The minutes will be sent to Regional Director/DPS (HQ) for approval within **5 days** of CCE meeting. The Regional Director/DPS (HQ) will convey his/her decision within **7 days** from receipt of the CCE recommendation.

Note: The deceased GDS for whom verification of educational certificates, caste certificates, Police verification etc. were not completed at the time of his/her death, family members of such deceased GDS will not be eligible for engagement on compassionate grounds till successful verification of all relevant/required documents.

Eligibility

- **(a)** Applicant for compassionate engagement should be eligible as per the criteria prescribed for engagement of GDS in GDS (Conduct & Engagement) Rules, 2020

(revised from time to time) and suitable for the post in all respects as per the conditions prescribed for normal regular selection to the GDS post for which being considered.

Relaxed Criteria

If a dependent of deceased GDS, willing for compassionate engagement does not possess requisite educational qualification at the time of submission of application on compassionate grounds, he/she may still be considered for engagement to the post of Dak Sevak on provisional basis provided:

- **(i)** He/she will be given up to a maximum of **3 years** to acquire minimum required educational qualification for engagement as regular GDS as prescribed under GDS [Conduct & Engagement] Rules, 2020.
- **(ii)** During his/her provisional engagement as Dak Sevak he/she will be given only the minimum of the TRCA (level-1) applicable to Dak Sevak and will not be entitled to annual increment till he/she attains the requisite educational qualification.
- **(iii)** Engagement of such Dak Sevak shall be provisional and liable to be terminated, as per provisions under Rule-8 of GDS (Conduct and Engagement) Rules, 2020.
- **(iv)** In the event of not acquiring minimum required educational qualification in the prescribed **3 years**-time from date of provisional engagement, the provisional engagement of the GDS will stand automatically terminated.
- **(v)** Transfer of such provisionally engaged GDS shall not be considered under Rule 3 of GDS (Conduct & Engagement) Rules, 2020 till completion of **two years** from regularization of engagement.

Note - 1: Age eligibility shall be determined with reference to the date of application and not the date of engagement.

Note - 2: Head of Division/Unit will keep a record of GDS engaged under relaxed criteria and will be responsible for ensuring that such GDS are not continued in engagement after **3 years** if they fail to acquire the requisite educational qualification.

Relaxation

There will be no relaxation in the upper age for the engagement on compassionate grounds. There will, however, be no upper age limit in respect of applicant spouse of the deceased.

Time Limits for Eligible Dependent of Deceased GDS for Submission of Application

- **(i)** In case there is eligible candidate in family and wants to apply, he/she has to submit application in all respect to IP/ASP of Sub Division/Unit at the earliest possible opportunity but not later than **two years** from the date of death of the GDS.
- **(ii)** In case there is no one eligible family member in the family, such member can apply for compassionate engagement within **two years** of attaining the requisite eligibility criteria.

Missing Gramin Dak Sevak

Cases of missing Gramin Dak Sevaks are also covered under the scheme for compassionate engagement subject to the following conditions:

- **(a)** A request for grant of compassionate engagement can be considered only after a lapse of at least **2 years** from the date from which the GDS has been missing, provided that:
 - **(i)** An FIR to this effect has been lodged with the police, and;
 - **(ii)** The missing person is not traceable and a police report to this effect is available, and
 - **(iii)** The competent authority feels that the case is genuine;
- **(b)** This benefit will not be applicable to a GDS:
 - **(i)** who had less than **two years** for normal discharge from service on the date from which he/she has been missing; or
 - **(ii)** who is suspected to have committed fraud or joined any terrorist organization or gone abroad.

- **(c)** Compassionate engagement in the case of a missing GDS also would not be a matter of right and it will be subject to the fulfilment of all the conditions, including availability of vacancy, laid down for such engagement under the scheme.
- **(d)** While considering such a request, the result of the Police investigation should be taken into account and
- **(e)** A decision on any such request shall be taken at the level of the Head of Region/Head of Circle only based on the recommendations of CCE.

Deceased Gramin Dak Sevaks (GDSs) who had Committed Frauds/Wrong Doing while in Engagement

- **(i)** The dependent family members of a GDS against whom a disciplinary/judicial proceeding was pending/contemplated at the time of death can be considered for compassionate engagement as the disciplinary proceedings stand abated on the death of the charged GDS.
- **(ii)** In case deceased GDS was involved in moral turpitude/misappropriation of the Government money and was awarded major penalty other than removal/dismissal in the past, the dependent family member will not be eligible for engagement on compassionate grounds.

Request for Change in Post/Person

- **(i)** Any request to change in post/person may be considered by the Competent Authority only before joining of the dependent.
- **(ii)** The Competent Authority to consider the request to change in post is DPS and in case to change person is HOR/HOC.
- **(iii)** Once the dependent family member of the deceased GDS has been offered engagement on compassionate grounds, the circumstances, which led to such engagement, will deem to have ceased to exist. Therefore:
 - **(a)** he/she should strive in his/her career like any other GDS for future advancement and any request for engagement to any higher post on consideration of compassion shall be rejected.

- (b) an engagement made on compassionate grounds cannot be transferred to any other person and any request for the same shall be rejected.

Seniority

Seniority of the person engaged as GDS on compassionate ground will be determined on the basis of his/her initial date of joining the GDS post and his/her position in the seniority list of GDS of the unit concerned will be determined accordingly.

Issue of Identity Card to Gramin Dak Sevaks (GDS)

- Identity cards will be issued free of cost to all Gramin Dak Sevaks, who are engaged after due engagement formalities as prescribed in GDS Conduct and Engagement Rules, amended time to time.
- A duplicate card can be issued to GDSs if the card is lost/stolen/invisible due to carelessness of GDSs by taking a fee of Rs. 50/-.
- At the time of Promotion/Discharge/Removal/Dismissal/Death/Transfer (to another Sub-Division/Division) of GDSs, the card will be returned/surrendered.
- While issuing identity cards to the GDS, the unique employee identity numbers assigned in CSI will mandatorily be mentioned on the identity cards.
- No identity card shall be issued to substitute engaged on leave vacancy.
- Identity cards will be valid for **five years** or till the date of discharge of GDS whichever is earlier.
- Fresh identity cards should be issued after every **five years**.